

The Lighthouse Keeper's Feather

Hidden treasure story • 11-12 years old



Chapter 1: The Stone with Scratches

Bramble Bear liked things tidy, honest, and fair. He was the kind of bear who returned lost berries to their baskets and lined up his fish bones in a neat row—mostly because it annoyed the crows.

On the first foggy morning of Leaf-Fall, Bramble was sweeping the steps of the old lighthouse on Pebble Point. The lighthouse hadn't shone in years, but Bramble visited anyway, because someone ought to.

His broom bristled over a loose stone. It wobbled, then tipped with a clack.

"What in the whiskers...?" Bramble muttered.

Underneath lay a flat slab carved with symbols—sharp triangles, looping spirals, and a tiny feather shape at the corner. The marks were filled with something dark, like dried ink.

Bramble crouched close. "These aren't claw scratches."

A voice behind him made him jump.

"Found treasure already?" chirped Juniper, a fox with bright eyes and a habit of appearing like she'd been waiting in your pocket. She carried a string bag full of apples that looked suspiciously borrowed.

"Not treasure," Bramble said firmly. "A clue. And those apples are...?"

"Rescued," Juniper said, grinning. "From the wind. Very dangerous wind. Anyway—symbols! Show me!"

Bramble shifted so she could see. The fog swirled around them, making the lighthouse steps feel like the edge of the world.

Juniper's nose twitched. "That spiral means 'turn' in old sailor code. My Aunt Tansy reads knot-patterns. She says spirals always mean turning."

"You're guessing," Bramble said, but his heart thumped with a hopeful rhythm.

Juniper tapped the triangle. "This could be a cliff. Or a mountain. Or a slice of cheese."

"There is no cheese mountain," Bramble said.

"You don't know that," Juniper said solemnly, then broke into a laugh.

Bramble studied the feather symbol. It was small, careful, like whoever carved it wanted to keep it safe.

"If this is old," Bramble said, "it could be important. But if we chase it, we must be responsible. No breaking things. No stealing. No—"

"No falling off cliffs," Juniper finished. "Agreed!"

Bramble lifted the stone and slid it back into place, leaving the carvings visible. "We'll copy it first. Properly."

He fetched a piece of charcoal from the lighthouse hearth and rubbed the symbols onto a sheet of bark. The shapes appeared, dark and clear, like a secret deciding to be seen.

Juniper bounced on her paws. "So where does it lead?"

Bramble looked at the spiral, the triangle, and the feather. Then he looked out into the foggy moorland beyond the point, where crooked pines leaned together as if whispering.

"We'll find out," he said. "But carefully."

And somewhere in the fog, a gull screamed as if it knew the answer and refused to tell.

Chapter 2: The Map That Wasn't a Map

They brought the charcoal rubbing to Mrs. Brindle, the oldest otter in Driftwood Village and the only creature who could remember three winters ago without sighing dramatically.

Mrs. Brindle ran a paw over the bark. "Hmm. Those are not sailor marks. Those are older. Stone-language. The cliff folk used it—before the lighthouse, before the village, before my knees started making their little songs."

"My knees sing too," Juniper said.

"That's called lying," Mrs. Brindle replied, without looking up.

Bramble leaned forward. "Can you read it?"

"I can read parts," Mrs. Brindle said. "The spiral means 'turn'—your fox is right. The triangle... yes, that's a peak. Not a cliff. And this line here—see it? It's a path."

Juniper squinted. "So it's a map!"

"A map that doesn't want to be one," Mrs. Brindle said. "It doesn't show the whole world. Only instructions."

Bramble's ears perked. Instructions felt manageable. He liked lists.

Mrs. Brindle pointed with a claw. "Turn at the peak. Follow the path. And the feather... that's the sign of the Keeper."

“The Keeper of what?” Bramble asked.

Mrs. Brindle’s whiskers quivered. “Of the hidden cache, if the old stories are true. They say a treasure was hidden when storms ate ships and greedy paws tried to claim what wasn’t theirs.”

Juniper’s eyes widened. “Treasure!”

Mrs. Brindle fixed her with a look. “Not jewels for showing off. The best treasures are the ones you don’t waste.”

Bramble nodded. That made sense. “So how do we start?”

Mrs. Brindle reached under her counter and produced a tiny glass lens, scratched but still clear. “Take this. It helps you see shallow carvings on rock. But you must return it.”

“I will,” Bramble promised. He meant it.

Juniper made a dramatic bow. “We shall protect your precious lens with our lives.”

Mrs. Brindle snorted. “Protect it with your brains. And, Bramble—”

“Yes?”

“If you find the cache,” she said softly, “don’t grab. Don’t rush. Think about why it was hidden.”

Bramble held the bark rubbing like it might fly away. “We will.”

Outside, the fog had lifted a little. The moor stretched wide, dotted with stones that looked like sleeping animals.

Juniper trotted beside him. “Do you think there’s a cursed skeleton guarding it?”

“Please don’t say ‘cursed’ while we’re walking through tall grass,” Bramble said.

Juniper smiled. “Fine. A very polite skeleton.”

Bramble tried not to laugh, but it escaped in a low huff. The adventure had begun, and he could already feel it pulling at him—mysterious, exciting, and just a bit chilly around the edges.

Chapter 3: The Peak That Pointed Back

They reached the first hill by midday. It wasn’t tall, but it rose sharply from the moor like a single tooth.

“That must be the peak,” Bramble said.

Juniper hopped onto a rock. “If it bites us, I’m blaming you.”

Bramble climbed more carefully, using his claws for grip. The wind smelled of damp stone and pine sap. At the top, they found a flat boulder with shallow carvings—almost invisible.

Bramble pulled out Mrs. Brindle’s lens and tilted it. The sunlight caught the grooves. A spiral. A triangle. And an arrow-like line.

Juniper leaned close. “It’s the same symbols, but... the arrow points that way.”

The arrow pointed back toward the sea.

“That’s odd,” Bramble said. “Why would it send us back?”

Juniper wagged her tail. “Maybe it’s testing us. Like, ‘Are you sure you want treasure? Are you sure you aren’t just hungry?’”

Bramble frowned. He was hungry, but that was beside the point.

He studied the spiral. “Turn at the peak,” he murmured. “Maybe we aren’t supposed to keep going forward. Maybe the ‘turn’ means turn around.”

Juniper’s ears drooped. “So we walked all this way to be told to do a U-turn.”

Bramble raised a paw. “Not wasted. We learned something.”

Juniper groaned. “You sound like a school sign.”

Bramble carefully traced the arrow with his claw. At the arrow’s tip was a tiny notch shaped like—he blinked—another feather.

“A second feather,” he said. “It’s pointing us toward... Pebble Point.”

“The lighthouse,” Juniper whispered.

They hurried down the hill. Clouds rolled in again, thick and gray, and the moor changed from friendly to confusing. Stones hid behind tussocks. Paths faded into nothing.

Juniper stopped suddenly. “Bramble.”

“What?”

“I think we’re being followed.”

Bramble froze. The grass shivered. A dark shape moved between the pines.

“Hello?” Bramble called, trying to sound brave and not like a bear who had once screamed at a falling pinecone.

The shape stepped out: a raven, sleek as spilled ink, with a shiny button pinned to his chest like a medal.

"Name's Rook," the raven said. "And you're walking on private curiosity."

Juniper bristled. "Curiosity isn't private."

Rook's eyes flicked to the bark rubbing in Bramble's paw. "Depends what it finds."

Bramble straightened. "We're not stealing anything. We're decoding symbols from the lighthouse steps. We'll return what we borrow."

Rook clicked his beak. "Responsible, huh? That's rare. Most treasure hunters are all grabby paws and empty promises."

Juniper whispered, "He's definitely grabby paws."

Rook heard her and smiled without warmth. "I'm a collector. Different."

Bramble held the lens tighter. "We're going back to the lighthouse. That's all you need to know."

Rook fluttered up onto a stone. "Oh, I know plenty. The Keeper's feather. The cache. The storm-box. I know the story."

Bramble's stomach tightened. "Storm-box?"

Rook's voice dropped. "Treasure that can change things. That's why it was hidden."

Juniper swallowed. "Change things how?"

Rook tilted his head. "Ask the sea. It remembers."

Then he spread his wings and vanished into the pines, leaving only a few loose feathers spinning down like black snow.

Bramble exhaled slowly. "We must be careful."

Juniper nodded, quieter now. "Careful and... faster."

Chapter 4: The Lighthouse's Secret Stair

Back at Pebble Point, the lighthouse stood against the sea like a tired giant. The fog curled around its base, and waves slapped the rocks with impatient hands.

Bramble led Juniper inside. Dust drifted in pale beams of light. The air smelled of salt and old smoke.

"The symbols were on the steps outside," Juniper said. "Maybe there are more inside."

Bramble scanned the floor. "No running. The boards might be weak."

Juniper tiptoed dramatically, lifting her paws high like a dancer. "I am the spirit of caution."

They found the spiral symbol again—this time carved into the wall beside a rusted lantern hook. Bramble used the lens. Next to the spiral was a set of tiny marks like tally lines, and below them, a feather.

"The Keeper again," Bramble murmured. He turned slowly, staring at the circular room. "Where would a Keeper hide something?"

Juniper pointed up. "In the top, obviously. Like a dramatic villain."

Bramble looked at the staircase winding around the inside wall. Halfway up, several steps were missing, leaving a jagged gap.

"That's not safe," Bramble said.

Juniper tried to sound brave. “We can jump it.”

Bramble imagined Juniper flying, remembered she was not a bird, and said, “No.”

He paced the room. The carvings showed a spiral and tally marks. Turn... and count?

“Turn and count,” he said aloud. “Maybe... turn the lantern hook and count something.”

Juniper perked up. “Yes! Do it! If it explodes, I’ll write a poem about you.”

“I’d prefer not to explode,” Bramble said, and gripped the lantern hook.

It creaked. He turned it gently to the right, matching the spiral’s direction. Once. Twice. Three times—matching the tally marks.

Click.

A faint seam appeared in the wall beside the hook, like a line drawn by moonlight. The stone shifted inward.

Juniper’s jaw dropped. “That is so unfair. I have been tugging on random things my whole life and none of them have secret doors.”

Bramble pushed, careful and slow. A narrow passage opened, revealing a hidden stair curling upward behind the lighthouse wall.

The air inside was cooler, smelling of wet rock and something metallic.

Juniper leaned close to Bramble. “This is it. This is the secret part where we find a chest and—”

“And we stay responsible,” Bramble reminded her.

They climbed the hidden stair. The stone steps were slick, and Bramble kept one paw behind Juniper in case she slipped.

At the top, the passage ended at a small chamber. In the center sat a carved stone pedestal with three shallow bowls. Above it, on the wall, were symbols—spirals, triangles, and a feather, all arranged like a sentence.

Bramble lifted the lens. The carvings were sharp here, as if made yesterday.

Juniper whispered, "It feels like someone's watching."

Bramble felt it too, but he focused on the pedestal. In the bowls were objects: a smooth pebble, a piece of dried seaweed, and an old copper coin.

"A puzzle," Juniper said, eyes gleaming.

Bramble nodded. "And puzzles don't care if you're scared."

He studied the wall symbols. The first was a triangle. Then a spiral. Then a feather.

"Peak. Turn. Keeper," Bramble translated. He looked at the bowls. Pebble... seaweed... coin.

Juniper guessed, "The coin is treasure. Put it under the feather?"

Bramble frowned. "But the feather is last. Maybe the order matters."

He stared harder until his thoughts slowed and lined up like stones in a riverbed. Peak. Turn. Keeper. What did they do at the peak? They turned back.

"Maybe we must choose the object that tells us to turn back," he said.

Juniper blinked. "That's... not the coin."

Bramble picked up the seaweed. It smelled like the ocean's pockets. He placed it in the first bowl under the triangle—because the peak pointed them toward the sea.

Then he placed the pebble in the second bowl under the spiral—because pebbles rolled and turned with waves.

The coin he placed in the last bowl under the feather.

For a moment, nothing happened.

Juniper's ears sagged. "Maybe the correct answer was 'cheese.'"

Then the pedestal shuddered. A thin line opened in the floor, and a hidden drawer slid out with a soft scrape.

Inside lay a small wooden box, dark and polished, with a feather carved on its lid.

Bramble's paw hovered above it. He remembered Mrs. Brindle's warning. Don't grab. Don't rush.

Juniper whispered, "Open it."

Bramble swallowed. "Not yet. We should think."

As if answering, footsteps sounded in the passage below—light, quick, and not at all careful.

Juniper hissed, "Rook."

Bramble's heart kicked. "Hide the box?"

Juniper looked at him, suddenly serious. "Or protect it."

Bramble lifted the box gently and held it to his chest. “We protect it. And we do it the right way.”

Chapter 5: The Raven’s Bargain

Rook appeared in the chamber entrance, feathers sleek, eyes bright with greedy curiosity.

“Well,” he said, “you found the Keeper’s gift. Congratulations. Now hand it over, and I won’t scream about you borrowing Mrs. Brindle’s lens without permission.”

Bramble’s ears flattened. “We did have permission. And we’re returning it.”

Rook’s beak clicked. “Sure. Of course. You’re practically a walking rulebook.”

Juniper stepped forward, tail fluffed up to twice its size. “Back off, button-chest. We got here first.”

Rook’s gaze slid to the box. “The storm-box. Imagine it—storms calmed or called, ships saved or sunk, all with a twist of a lock. I could trade that power for anything.”

Bramble tightened his grip. “Power isn’t treasure if it hurts others.”

Rook laughed softly. “That’s adorable. You really believe that?”

“I believe in responsibility,” Bramble said, voice steady even though his legs wanted to run. “If this was hidden, it was hidden for a reason.”

Rook took a step closer. “Then be responsible and give it to someone who can use it.”

Juniper muttered, “That is the worst argument I’ve ever heard.”

Bramble backed toward the wall, keeping the box away. His eyes flicked to the carvings. Triangle. Spiral. Feather.

An idea sparked—small but sharp.

“Rook,” Bramble said, “you said you know the story. Then you know the Keeper set tests.”

Rook paused. “So?”

“So the last test is for the one who tries to take it,” Bramble said, bluffing with all the courage he could scrape together. “If you grab it, the lighthouse will trap you.”

Juniper’s eyes widened, but she caught on fast. She clutched her chest dramatically. “Oh yes. The Trapping. Very... trap-like.”

Rook hesitated, eyes narrowing. “You’re lying.”

Bramble lifted the lens and angled it so sunlight flashed across the carvings. “See this shallow line? It’s not just decoration. It’s a mechanism mark.”

It wasn’t. It was just a crack. But it looked convincing under the lens.

Rook’s claws flexed. “Fine. Then open it yourself. Show me.”

Bramble’s mind raced. If he opened it, and it was dangerous—if it truly could “change storms”—that wasn’t something to wave around.

He looked at Juniper. She gave a tiny nod, trusting him.

Bramble set the box on the pedestal and did not open it. Instead, he slid it slightly—turning it so the feather carving lined up with the feather on the wall.

Click.

A soft gust of air whooshed from the floor seam, and a second drawer slid out—empty except for a folded strip of bark.

Juniper blinked. “There’s more?”

Bramble unfolded the bark. It showed one symbol: a feather. And beneath it, simple words scratched in old, careful writing:

RETURN WHAT YOU CARRY. KEEP WHAT YOU LEARN.

Bramble felt his throat tighten.

Rook leaned in. “That’s it? A message?”

Bramble picked up the box again, calmer now. “It means the real treasure isn’t something you take. It’s something you protect.”

Rook’s eyes flashed. “No. There’s always more. There’s always a hidden compartment.”

Juniper said, “Maybe the hidden compartment is your heart.”

Rook stared at her. “I don’t have one. I traded it for this button.”

Bramble couldn’t help a small huff of laughter, then turned serious. “Rook, this belongs to the Keeper’s rules. Not you. Not us.”

Rook’s wings twitched. For a moment, he looked less smug and more... unsure, like a bird who’d flown too far and forgotten why.

Then he snapped back. “I’ll take my chances.”

He lunged.

Bramble reacted without thinking. He stepped sideways—just as he’d done at

the peak when he turned back—and Rook’s claws scraped empty air. Rook stumbled, slamming into the pedestal.

The bowls rattled. The coin flipped out, clinked on stone, and rolled into a groove in the floor—straight into a tiny hole shaped like a feather.

Click.

The chamber trembled. A section of the wall slid open behind Bramble, revealing a narrow chute leading down.

Juniper gasped. “Secret escape!”

Rook spun, feathers ruffled. “No! That’s the real way!”

Bramble grabbed Juniper’s paw. “Go!”

They dove into the chute. It was steep and slick, like sliding down a wet log. Bramble held the box tight with one paw and Juniper with the other.

Behind them, Rook shrieked in fury, but the wall slammed shut with a final, heavy thud.

They shot out the bottom of the chute into a pile of soft, dusty sand in a small sea cave. Water dripped from the ceiling. The sound of waves echoed like distant drums.

Juniper lay on her back, breathing hard. “That... was... amazing.”

Bramble sat up, checking her for scrapes. “Are you hurt?”

“Only in my pride,” she said. “I screamed a little.”

“I screamed on the inside,” Bramble admitted.

They both laughed—quietly, because the cave felt like it was listening.

Chapter 6: The Hidden Cache

The cave opened to a narrow strip of beach tucked between black rocks. The tide was low, revealing a path of shining stones like scattered stars.

Bramble held up the box. “We still haven’t found the cache.”

Juniper pointed at the rocks. “Look.”

Carved into the cliff wall, just above the damp line of the tide, were the familiar symbols. Triangle. Spiral. Feather. And a new one: a circle with a dot, like an eye.

Bramble used the lens. The carvings were worn but clear.

“The eye,” Bramble said. “Maybe it means ‘look.’”

Juniper grinned. “That’s my favorite instruction.”

They searched the cliff face. Bramble ran his paw along cracks and bumps, feeling for anything that didn’t belong. Juniper poked her nose into every crevice, sneezing whenever she found ancient dust.

“There!” Juniper said, voice muffled. Her snout was pressed to a narrow opening behind a curtain of hanging seaweed.

Bramble pulled the seaweed aside. Set into the rock was a stone door, no larger than a beehive, with a feather-shaped indentation.

“The box,” Juniper whispered. “It’s a key.”

Bramble hesitated. “If it’s dangerous—”

Juniper's tone softened. "Then we're extra careful. Like... you."

Bramble took a slow breath and fitted the box into the feather indentation. It clicked into place as neatly as a puzzle piece.

The stone door shifted open with a sigh, revealing a small chamber inside the cliff. No glittering piles. No crowns. No jewel-stuffed goblets.

Instead, there was a waterproof satchel, sealed with wax. Next to it lay a bundle wrapped in cloth, and a note carved into a wooden plaque:

FOR THE ONE WHO FINDS THIS:

USE WHAT YOU MUST.

LEAVE WHAT YOU SHOULD.

REMEMBER WHO IT'S FOR.

Bramble's chest felt warm and heavy at the same time.

Juniper poked the satchel. "Open it?"

Bramble nodded and unsealed it carefully. Inside were rolled papers—maps of dangerous currents, notes about safe coves, and a list of ship signals. Practical things. Life-saving things.

"There's more," Juniper said, unwrapping the cloth bundle.

Inside lay a small brass instrument—a weather gauge, polished and sturdy—and a slim leather pouch. Juniper opened the pouch and poured out... seeds.

"Seeds?" she said, disappointed for about one second, then curious. "Why seeds?"

Bramble lifted the note again. "For the one who finds this. It's not about getting rich. It's about helping."

He looked at the maps. "These could keep sailors from crashing at Pebble Point. And the gauge could warn the village before storms."

Juniper held the seeds up to the dim cave light. "And these could grow windbreak trees. Or cliff flowers. Or—wait—what if they're rare?"

Bramble smiled. "Either way, they're meant to be used wisely."

Juniper's voice turned thoughtful. "So the treasure is... responsibility."

Bramble chuckled. "You make it sound like a disappointing sandwich."

Juniper laughed too. "It's just... I expected at least one shiny thing."

Bramble reached into the satchel again and pulled out a single shiny object: a small metal pin shaped like a feather, silver and simple.

Juniper's eyes lit up. "Shiny!"

Bramble read the tiny words etched on the back: KEEPER.

He looked at Juniper. "I think this is the true prize. Not to own, but to remind the Keeper what to do."

Juniper's grin softened. "So... you're the Keeper?"

Bramble swallowed. The word felt too big for his paws. But then he imagined the village safe, storms predicted, sailors guided. He imagined Rook with power and no care, and his fur bristled.

"I can't do it alone," Bramble said. "But I can start."

Juniper bumped her shoulder against his. “Good. Because I’m coming too. Someone has to make sure you don’t get boring.”

Bramble glanced toward the cave entrance. “We should take this to Mrs. Brindle. And the village council.”

Juniper made a face. “Council meetings. My greatest enemy.”

“Responsible,” Bramble reminded her.

Juniper sighed. “Fine. But I’m bringing snacks.”

As they stepped onto the beach, the sky outside had cleared into a bright, windy afternoon. The sea looked less like a threat and more like a giant blue puzzle.

Behind them, far above in the lighthouse, something clattered—maybe a trapped raven, maybe only old stones settling. Bramble didn’t look back. He had work to do.

Chapter 7: A Feather Put Away

Driftwood Village listened in a hush as Bramble and Juniper spread the maps on Mrs. Brindle’s counter. The mayor—a plump badger who wore a hat too small for his head—blinked at the storm notes as if they were written in lightning.

“These currents,” Mrs. Brindle murmured, eyes shining. “These are accurate. Look here—this mark warns of the pulling undertow by Needle Rock. We’ve lost boats there.”

Juniper stood on her toes. “Not anymore.”

Bramble placed the brass weather gauge gently on the table. “We can mount it near the harbor bell. When pressure drops, we warn everyone.”

The badger mayor cleared his throat importantly. “And the seeds?”

“Plant them along the cliff path,” Bramble said. “A windbreak. Fewer falls. Safer journeys.”

Mrs. Brindle watched Bramble closely. “And the box?”

Bramble took it out and set it down. “It was a key, not a weapon. And this—” He held up the silver feather pin. “This is the Keeper mark.”

The room was quiet for a moment. Even Juniper didn’t joke.

Mrs. Brindle nodded once. “Then you know what to do next.”

Bramble looked at the pin in his paw. It gleamed, small but steady, like a promise.

Juniper whispered, “Are you scared?”

Bramble admitted, “Yes. But being scared doesn’t mean stopping.”

She grinned. “Good. Because I already told three kids you found a secret cave, and now they think you’re legendary.”

Bramble groaned. “Juniper!”

“What? It’s motivational,” she said. “Also, slightly untrue in places.”

They worked for days. Bramble helped mount the weather gauge. He copied the maps and posted warnings. He and Juniper planted seeds in straight lines—Juniper tried to plant them in the shape of her name, but Bramble made her redo it “for proper root spacing.”

They even made a new rule: no one went near Pebble Point alone in rough weather. Bramble wrote it neatly. Juniper drew a tiny angry wave next to it.

As for Rook, he didn't appear again. Sometimes a black feather would show up on the lighthouse step, like a sour little goodbye. Bramble left it there. Some lessons had to land when they were ready.

One evening, when the sky was a soft orange and the sea finally looked gentle, Bramble returned to the lighthouse with Mrs. Brindle's lens.

He placed it on her counter with care. "Thank you," he said.

Mrs. Brindle smiled. "You returned what you carried."

Bramble touched the feather pin in his pocket. "And I kept what I learned."

At home, in his small den under the pines, Bramble opened a wooden chest where he stored important things: his father's old compass, a smooth stone from his first solo hike, and a bundle of letters tied with string.

He held the silver feather pin for a moment, feeling its cool weight. Responsibility wasn't loud. It didn't sparkle like a pile of coins. But it held the village together like good knots on a strong rope.

Juniper's voice floated in from outside. "Bramble! If you're being noble in there, hurry up! I found a suspiciously unguarded pie on a windowsill!"

Bramble called back, "Juniper! That's stealing!"

"It's borrowing!" she shouted. "And I will return the plate!"

Bramble shook his head, smiling. "Wait for me."

He placed the feather pin inside the chest, tucked it into a small cloth pocket, and closed the lid with a firm click.

The feather was put away—safe, ready, and waiting for the next time courage and careful thinking were needed.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What did Bramble use to copy the carved symbols found under the loose step at the lighthouse?

- Charcoal rubbed onto a piece of bark
- Ink and paper from Mrs. Brindle
- A pencil and a scrap of cloth
- Paint and a shell

2) Which item did Mrs. Brindle lend to help see shallow carvings on rock?

- A small glass lens
- A brass weather gauge
- A wooden ruler
- A magnifying map

3) What did the message inside the wooden box say about carrying and learning?

- RETURN WHAT YOU CARRY. KEEP WHAT YOU LEARN.
- TAKE WHAT YOU FIND. SHARE WHAT YOU KNOW.
- HIDE WHAT IS DANGEROUS. TEACH WHAT IS USEFUL.
- KEEP WHAT YOU WANT. GIVE AWAY WHAT YOU DO NOT

4) How did the wooden box function when Bramble placed it in the stone door on the cliff?

- It acted as a key that clicked and opened the stone door
- It exploded to scare away Rook
- It melted and revealed a map inside the rock
- It turned into a weather gauge

5) Which three objects did Bramble place in the pedestal bowls to open the hidden drawer?

- Seaweed in the first, a pebble in the second, and the coin in the third
- A shell in the first, a feather in the second, and a map in the third
- A candle in the first, a stone in the second, and a key in the third
- A leaf in the first, a coin in the second, and a shard of glass in the third

6) What practical items were found in the satchel inside the cliff

cache that showed the treasure was for helping others?

- Maps of currents, a brass weather gauge, and packets of seeds
- Gold coins, a crown, and a jeweled compass
- A magic spellbook, a crystal, and a feathered cloak
- A list of names, a diary, and a family crest

Correct answers:

1) Charcoal rubbed onto a piece of bark 2) A small glass lens 3) RETURN WHAT YOU CARRY. KEEP WHAT YOU LEARN. 4) It acted as a key that clicked and opened the stone door 5) Seaweed in the first, a pebble in the second, and the coin in the third 6) Maps of currents, a brass weather gauge, and packets of seeds

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Bristled: When something's surface stands up in short, stiff pieces or hairs.

Slab: A large, flat piece of stone or wood.

Hearth: The floor area near a fireplace, where fires were made for warmth.

Rubbing: A picture made by rubbing charcoal or pencil over paper on a carved surface.

Lens: A curved piece of glass that makes things look clearer or bigger.

Tally lines: Short marks made in a row to count or record numbers.

Pedestal: A low stand that holds or shows an object.

Satchel: A small bag used to carry papers or tools.

Waterproof: Not letting water pass through; keeps things dry inside.

Wax: A soft, sticky material used to seal or cover something closed.

Chute: A sloping tube or passage that lets things or people slide down.

Seam: A thin line where two pieces of material or rock meet.

Indentation: A small hollow or cut pushed into a surface.

Undertow: A strong, pulling current under the surface that moves water away from shore.